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Martin Cook

SKILLS

Twenty-five years of experience in high-end creative projects for film, television, corporate communications, and digital marketing, I lead teams of artists and technicians to deliver excellence across the creative industries. I build both in-house and independent collectives to achieve clients' creative goals.

MANAGING DIRECTOR, VFX

ARTIST, MOTION-ARTIST, EDITOR, DIRECTOR, PRODUCER, CTO, CONSULTANT.

EXPERIENCE

Orchard Post Ltd, London – *Managing Director*

Jan 2008 – PRESENT www.orchardpost.com

- Since 2008, I have divided my time between freelancing as a VFX and motion artist and managing Orchard Post, a fully functional post-production facility that I established to take on larger projects. I built the facility myself over many years, leveraging both my technical and artistic skills. This included tasks such as setting up building custom workstations, networks and media servers, as well as implementing effective working practices and project management strategies.
- Orchard Post has successfully completed high-end projects across the media industry, including VFX for feature films, TV and commercials for global brands, large-scale live events, and more. I have provided a couple of case studies below that illustrate my ability to manage large teams of creatives across various disciplines, while also highlighting my capabilities as a producer, director and artist.
- Part of my technical duties are to maintain over 25+ workstations, servers, Ai LLMs and render GPUs racks. This includes all network design and administration. I am qualified in CompTIA A+ Core 1&2. I am currently studying for the Cyber+ & AI+ CompTIA pathway.
- <https://orchardpost.com/case-studies/>

MPC, London – *Head of Design*

JAN 2005 – JAN 2008

- This department was known for its high pressure and demanding environment within one of the World's leading post houses. However, I thrived in this atmosphere of creativity and gained invaluable working practices. This experience also allowed me to develop exceptional team leadership skills.
- I implemented changes at every level within the department, including a complete transition from a file transfer suite to a compositing, effects, and support area. Additionally, I organized training courses and increased staffing levels, which significantly improved workflow. I fostered strong working relationships with engineers and computer suppliers to minimize downtime on all machines.
- Moreover, I introduced new work practices that assigned specific tasks to individual operators, maximizing their personal strengths. I also took on the responsibility for managing all rotas, holiday schedules, pay reviews, and the day-to-day operations of the department, all while fulfilling my duties as the lead visual effects artist.

MPC, London – *Motion/Vfx Artist*

JAN 2000 – DEC 2004

- Some other Film and TV work completed:
- Wimbledon the movie: (Matte Painter, Compositor).
- Harry Potter franchise: (Roto, Compositor).
- Match Point: (VFX Supervisor, Compositor).
- Tomb Raider: (Roto, Compositor).
- Troy: (Compositor).
- Octane: (Title design).
- Al Jazeera Rebrand News Channel: (Designer, Animator).
- The Sun "We love Balls": (VFX supervisor).
- Kano "Feel Free": (VFX supervisor, 3D artist, Compositor).
- Maynards 'Troll': (Animator, Compositor).
- BTCC Opening Credits: (ITV1) (Designer, animator, compositor).
- Primal Scream 'Some velvet morning': (Designer, Animator).
- Tim Burgess 'About a boy': (Compositor, animator).
- (BBC) Bleak House: (Compositor).
- (BBC) The Link: (3D Artist, designer).
- System experience: MacOSX/Windows/Linux/Unix

Client feedback

-Mark Rose

Group Brand Manager – BP

“Martin and the team at Orchard Post have created some very high profile and strategically important work for BP in recent years. Animated content that has appeared online and on TV. With Orchard Post you get a very personal and committed team coupled with an excellent perspective on animation and the right solution for the brief. I think Orchard Post will become an even more important partner for BP the new digital future”.

-John Callaghan

Senior Creative Manager – Global Media & Entertainment Group

“Orchard has been an absolute pleasure to work with and quickly became an extension of the creative team here at Global. We had a relatively small budget to try and do something big with and the guys pulled it off. From character design through to look development and the finished animation the work has been of a really high standard. Orchard couldn’t do more for us and even rose to the challenge of having to produce an extra animated shot one week before the deadline. I would highly recommend them.

-Carla Greco

Digital Communications Manager – UK Government RWM

“I worked with Martin on a project like no other: a suite of three animations – in 3D – that explains how we manage radioactive waste in the UK and why. I found the Orchard team collaborative, easy to talk to and happy to work with us with the scripts we provided. The three animations have charm, tell the story clearly, flow easily and are currently receiving very good reviews at our public events. I’m very pleased with Orchard’s work and would work with them again.”

-Adam S Pereira

Managing Director at Video Alchemists

“What can I say but – wow! The job you guys have done in the timeframe we had is nothing short of remarkable. We’ve worked with a plethora of suppliers over the last two years and I can honestly say that your team ranks near the top for us. On this project, it isn’t just the quality of the work which has been fantastic, but the attitude of everyone involved has been exceptional which makes such a difference to how we’ve felt under the expectations and pressures of one of our biggest clients”.

-Mary Fitzgerald

Executive Producer at TAG

“Absolute superstar. Martin has massively helped me build my graphics offering with his expertise, he has introduced us to new workflows and ways of working. His creative flair coupled with his ability to get the job done is invaluable.”

-Mark Bird

Media Director at West End Studios

“Martin provides the very best in design and operates at the highest Professional levels. His portfolio and client list is exceptional and a Testimony to his skill set. Thoroughly recommended.”

-Ali Owen-Thomas

Events Services Director

“Martin is the most talented Artist I have had the pleasure to work with. His showreel speaks volumes. Simply seeing his work will do more than any recommendation I may give.”

EDUCATION

WEST HERTS COLLEGE, Watford – *HND Media Production Management*

SEPT 1997 – JULY 1999

Southwark College, London – *BTEC National Audio Visual Communication*

SEPT 1995 – JULY 1997

AWARDS

First Life David Attenborough

EMMY

2011

Outstanding Graphic Design & Art Direction